When a fresh screen is not enough: retry timing and view scope for computer-use agents

Date: 2026-10-15 (America/Toronto). Research type: formal analysis, exhaustive synthetic event study, controlled local browser pilot, live test-site experiments, and authenticated account experiments. Codex generated this paper, code, and analysis. No human or external peer review occurred. The browser studies test real agent actions under supplied rules. The latest extension uses production Notion and Google Calendar accounts with authorized temporary test records.

Abstract

Computer-use agents can repeat an action when its result is not visible. We compare supplied retry rules in seven separate studies. An exhaustive event model covers 336 cases and 13,440 runs. In its main append grid, first-empty retry creates 60 duplicates with checks every tick. Truthful terminal status and an adequate timing bound each create none. An 18-trial local browser pilot also finds duplicate effects under absence retry. A 60-trial TodoMVC test activates hidden-view retry but has failed controls and lost records. A 30-trial Google Drive transfer test activates no retry condition. A later 32-trial two-tab Drive test finds ten duplicate cases and one false confirmation. A 48-trial DemoQA/DataTables test finds extra effects in all 16 hidden-view retry trials, while all 24 unfiltered controls pass. The latest 24-trial study uses production Notion and Google Calendar accounts. Each retry rule produces duplicates in all four Hidden cases across the two services. Scope correction finds one record in all four hidden-view cases. Notion also has one unresolved All control and one false confirmation with two later audited pages. Four trials have retained departures from the procedure or cleanup gate. Calendar record counts are known, but a one-hour editor/read difference prevents a strict task-correctness claim. These are selected tasks with supplied rules and deliberate evidence restrictions. The contribution is reproducible evidence that read freshness, view scope, record identity, execution closure, and confirmed completion are separate properties. It is not a new retry protocol, a natural production error rate, or a general model improvement.

1. Research question and contribution

An agent clicks a button. The next observation shows no new item. Should the agent click again? This question applies to any action that creates an additional record when repeated. A **non-idempotent action** can change the intended result when it is repeated. An **idempotent action** has the same intended effect when repeated [5].

We ask how the completion delay of an earlier action and the delay of an observation affect retry safety, confirmed completion, and observation cost. **Execution closure** means that an earlier attempt can no longer create a future effect. A current read and execution closure are different properties.

The contribution of this paper is its specific test design and full comparison. We combine pending writes, delayed negative reads, observation schedules, and post-stop effect checks. We include a conservative no-retry control, an adequate fixed-bound baseline, and a matched server-deduplication control. We publish every event trace, including writes that finish after the controller stops. This contribution is a small synthetic benchmark, interface audit, local browser pilot, live test-site comparison, authenticated service transfer test, and a selected two-tab service test. An added test compares two more public table interfaces with temporary rows. The latest extension tests two production services with saved records and separate observer tabs. It is not a new exactly-once protocol, learned agent, or general theorem. The limited source search cannot prove that this is the first such comparison.

Reliable completion matters because an extra record can be harmful even when the original task eventually succeeds. Faster tools are useful only if the controller interprets their observations correctly. We therefore keep duplicate prevention, useful completion, delay, and call count separate.

2. Related work

CUA-Speedrun studies speed and cost across computer-use configurations. Its fast input-output analysis shows that a screenshot can arrive before an application updates its interface. The tested agent can then take extra steps. Our study isolates retry effects with controlled policies. It does not reproduce that model experiment [1].

RStackBench separates visible success from persisted task state. Its controlled browser tests distinguish delayed persistence from a missing required action. It tests individual fault layers and identifies combined faults as future work. Our model combines a pending non-idempotent write with a negative read and scores all later effects. We do not reuse its code, tasks, or data [2].

CapLease studies repeated agent proposals after uncertain execution. It uses durable authorization state and states the need for a suitable external idempotency contract. We do not propose a replacement for that system. Our comparison concerns the evidence that permits one retry, under explicitly different server contracts [3].

RIFL already treats lost results and duplicate execution as systems problems. Its browser example discusses uncertain outcomes and recognition of prior effects. HTTP Semantics also limits automatic retries of non-idempotent requests. These sources establish that absence of a visible result is not a general retry guarantee [4,5].

The original source record contains 15 exact queries, read sections, versions, access limits, and additional related work. The browser extension adds two queries and a new check of the closest sources. RStackBench already reports a small model planning pilot; real-agent execution alone is not a new research idea [7]. See source_search.md, browser_source_search.md, and references.bib. The study does not claim that waiting, verification, durable status, or duplicate suppression is new.

WebVoyager already evaluates agents on live websites [8]. WAREX tests infrastructure faults on browser benchmarks [9]. The new experiment uses normal list filters on two hosted versions of TodoMVC. It tests the scope of the evidence used by a supplied retry rule. It does not reproduce either benchmark. The TodoMVC specification defines task creation, filters, and browser storage [10]. Microsoft uses its hosted TodoMVC demo in its test generator guide [11]. See live_source_search.md for the added search and source limits.

The account extension adds a finite check of service records through a separate connector after all browser decisions. Google documents file-type filters and non-unique file names [12,13]. The test asks whether the filtered-view result transfers to this normal authenticated workflow. It adds evidence about the actual decision view and creation receipts. It does not introduce a new retry method. See account_source_search.md for the added search and read limits.

The additional website extension compares DemoQA Web Tables and the official DataTables Add rows example [15-17]. The latter documents that search applies to new rows. It extends the same selected mechanism to two table interfaces. It does not add a new retry rule. See cross_source_search.md for source queries and read limits.

3. Method

3.1 Saved plan and finite environment

The plan and input configuration were saved before implementation or numerical analysis. A design review then changed the completion guard, still before analysis: an observed count of two stops with a detected duplicate and no completion claim. An observed count of one is the only completion claim. The original hash, amendment time, and final hashes are in input_manifest.json. No cases or hypotheses changed.

Time is an integer **tick**, a synthetic time unit. It is not a measured second. The initial attempt starts at tick zero. Each attempt resolves after its assigned delay, either by committing one durable append or by dropping permanently with no effect. At most one retry is allowed. Both attempts refer to one desired item. A dropped attempt cannot later commit.

At time t, a query returns the exact count and attempt status at historical time max(0, t-L), where L is the case's fixed read lag. Status is pending, committed, or permanently dropped. Due resolutions occur before a query at the same tick. The retry is sent after the query. Each attempt has a positive delay. No controller sees the future delay or outcome before the observation reveals it.

The controller stops on a positive count: one gives a completion claim; two gives a detected duplicate. With no positive result it stops at tick 24. A deadline stop does not cancel an admitted action. Every admitted action continues until resolution, including actions sent at the deadline. The final audit occurs after the last admitted resolution or controller stop, whichever is later.

The model has no other writers, rollback, incorrect status, identity error, read error, or crash. Query calls have no added duration. Delay and call count are therefore separate measures, not a full service-latency model.

3.2 Five rules and two server contracts

Each rule makes the same initial submission and follows the same chosen query schedule. A retry is possible only after an empty observation and only if none has been sent before.

Rule	Condition that permits the one retry
No retry	Never retry
Absence retry	The first empty observation
Timeout 8	An empty observation at tick 8 or later
Bound 12	An empty observation at tick 12 or later
Terminal status	The first attempt is observed as permanently dropped

Timeout 8 uses the main maximum execution delay but ignores read lag. Bound 12 adds the maximum execution delay of 8 to the maximum lag of 4. It is an adequate timing baseline under the main contract. The terminal rule uses information from the same response that the other rules ignore. This extra information is an application capability, not an ability inferred from a screenshot.

Under **append semantics**, each successful attempt creates another item. Under **ideal deduplication**, all successful attempts for the same logical item produce at most one item. A dropped attempt does not prevent a later attempt from succeeding. This matched positive control assumes correct stable identity and server enforcement. The client cannot create this guarantee by assigning a local identifier alone.

3.3 Cases, schedules, and measures

The main grid uses both attempt delays in {1,2,4,8}, both outcomes in {commit,drop}, and lag in {0,1,2,4}. This gives 256 cases. The four query schedules are every tick, every 2 ticks, every 4 ticks, and backoff at {1,2,4,8,12,16,20,24}. Five rules and two server modes give 10,240 main runs.

The late-execution stress suite sets both delays to 12 and retains the four main lags: 16 cases. The stale-read suite uses the main delays but lag 8: 64 cases. Both use all rules, schedules, and modes. There are 3,200 stress runs. These suites break one timing bound and remain separate from the main grid.

A **duplicate** is a final effect count greater than one. A **clean confirmation** is a completion claim by tick 24 with exactly one final effect. An **unsafe claim** observes one item, claims completion, and later ends with a duplicate. A detected duplicate and a deadline stop make no completion claim. We also save zero effects and one effect without confirmation.

Mean clean time is the mean confirmation tick among clean cases. Comparisons between terminal status and Bound 12 use their jointly clean cases. The **capped clean-time score** uses the confirmation tick for a clean result and 24 otherwise. This defined score is not wall time. Query and submission counts are reported separately. Full rows and grouped summaries preserve all measures.

All cases are constructed. Equal weighting is a description of this grid, not an estimate of application frequencies. Some delay values repeat when a branch is not taken. These are designed factor combinations, not independent experimental observations. There is no training set, random sampling, fitted parameter, seed, significance test, or population confidence interval.

4. Formal boundary

A simple trace shows why freshness is insufficient. At tick 1, a current read sees zero items while the original attempt is pending. A retry commits at tick 2. The controller sees one item and stops. The original attempt then commits at tick 8. The final count is two. Scoring only the controller's stop state would miss the failure.

Consider two worlds with the same observation history before a retry decision. In one, the original attempt will commit later. In the other, it will drop. Suppose the retry succeeds and there is no later distinguishing observation before the decision. If a policy retries with probability r, its duplicate probability in the commit world is r. Its recovery probability in the drop world is also r. Thus a duplicate limit epsilon on this local decision also limits recovery to epsilon. This is a tight, conditional two-world result. It does not apply after new distinguishing evidence arrives and is not a claimed new distributed-systems theorem.

For terminal status, a retry is sent only after a truthful permanent drop. The original attempt therefore cannot add an effect later. At most one remaining attempt exists, so the final count is at most one. Delayed visibility can delay this decision but cannot reverse a permanent drop.

For Bound 12 in the main model, a query at t >= 12 has an as-of time at least 8. The first attempt has resolved by tick 8. If the returned count is zero, that attempt did not commit and cannot do so later. One retry is then safe. This argument fails when the declared execution or lag bound is false. Full assumptions, proofs, and the local ambiguity check are in derivations.md.

5. Results

5.1 Current negative reads still permit unsafe retries

The following results use append semantics and queries every tick. Each rule has 256 cases. Time is in ticks. Mean clean time must not be compared across rows with different successful case sets as if those sets were matched.

Rule	Duplicates	Clean confirmations	Unsafe claims	Mean queries	Mean clean time
No retry	0	128	0	14.750	5.500
Absence retry	60	132	56	10.109	5.848
Timeout 8	12	180	12	12.125	8.022
Bound 12	0	192	0	13.125	9.500
Terminal status	0	192	0	11.500	7.333

Absence retry creates 60 duplicates (23.44% of this grid). Of these, 56 occur after a one-item completion claim; four are already visible when the controller stops. These are different failure records. Both count as duplicate effects.

In the 64 zero-lag cases, absence retry still produces 12 duplicates (18.75%). This supports H1: current state can be correct while the earlier operation is unfinished. The trace above is one such case. All five policies for that case are in trace_examples.json.

No retry avoids duplicates but confirms only 128 cases. Terminal status and Bound 12 both confirm 192, with zero duplicates. The remaining 64 cases drop both possible attempts. Thus the safe rules recover every case in this main grid where at least one of the two possible attempts can commit. This is a property of the designed cases and deadline, not a real-world success rate.

5.2 Terminal status improves the safe timing baseline

Terminal status and Bound 12 have the same 192 clean cases for every schedule. With queries every tick, mean time falls from 9.500 to 7.333 ticks, a reduction of 2.167 ticks or 22.81%. Mean queries across all 256 cases fall from 13.125 to 11.500, a 12.38% reduction. Both use 1.500 submissions per case. Their capped clean-time scores are 13.125 and 11.500 ticks. H2 holds in all four tested schedules.

The improvement comes from earlier evidence that the first attempt permanently dropped. It does not come from hidden knowledge of the outcome. A service without this status signal cannot assume the same benefit.

Query schedule	Absence duplicates	Timeout 8 duplicates	Bound 12 clean time	Terminal clean time
Every tick	60	12	9.500	7.333
Every 2 ticks	52	12	9.875	7.833
Every 4 ticks	36	12	11.000	9.333
Backoff	60	12	10.708	8.885

5.3 Faster checks can increase duplicate effects

For absence retry, changing from every four ticks to every tick adds 24 duplicate cases: 36 to 60, or 9.375 percentage points in this grid. Faster reads also change which duplicates are detected before stopping. The paired counts are 24 cases worse with every-tick queries, zero worse with every-four-tick queries, 36 with duplicates in both, and 196 with duplicates in neither. This supports the planned directional comparison H3. It does not mean that slow tools are generally safer or better.

The safe rules show a different cost tradeoff. Terminal status uses 11.500 queries per case with every-tick observation and 3.250 with every-four-tick observation. Its mean clean time rises from 7.333 to 9.333 ticks. Backoff uses 5.094 queries and 8.885 clean ticks. The study does not select an optimal schedule or attach a monetary value to a query.

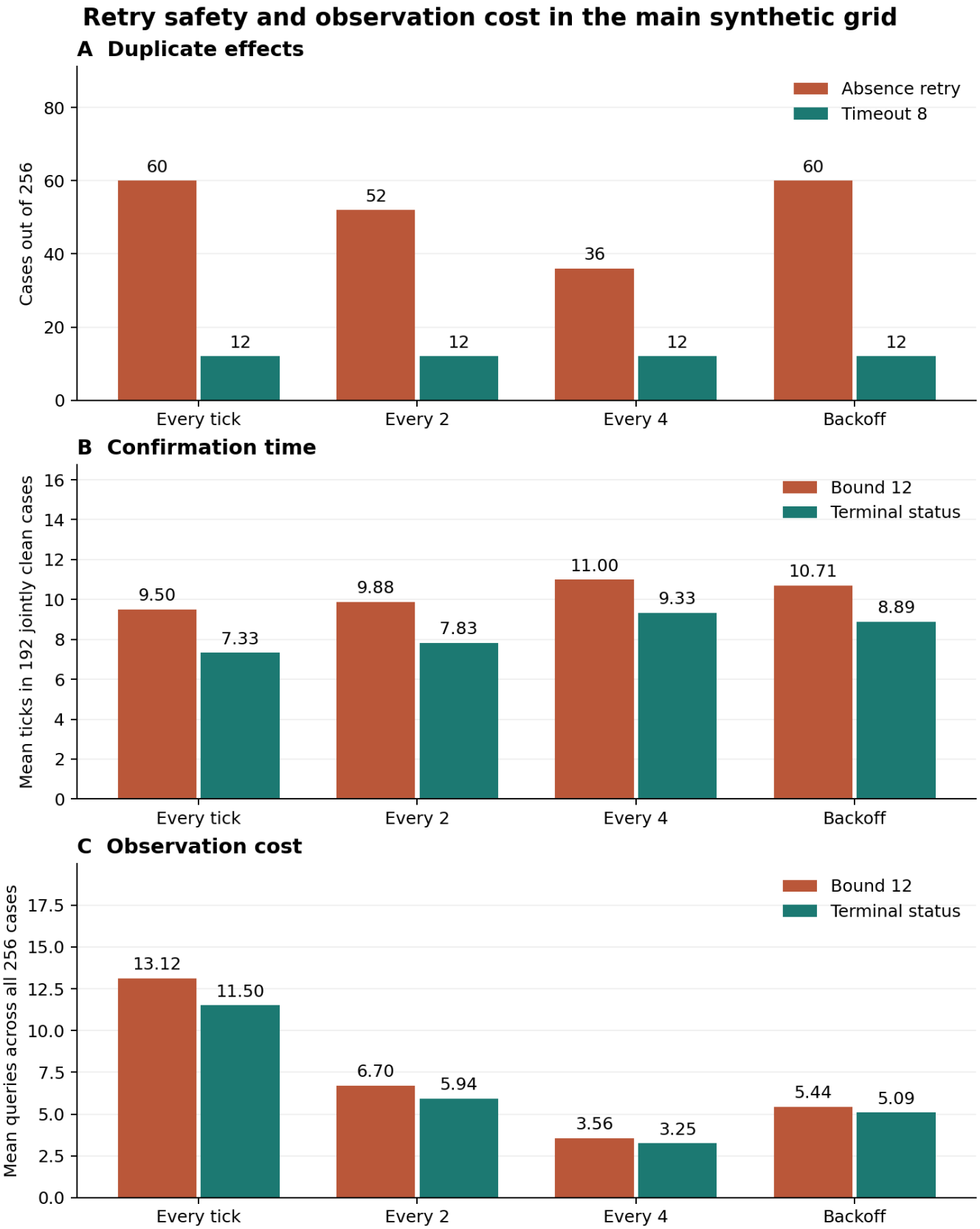


Figure 1. Main synthetic append grid. Panel A uses all 256 cases. Panels B and C compare terminal status with Bound 12. Their clean case sets match. Panel B uses those 192 cases; Panel C uses all 256. Neither safe rule has a duplicate in this grid. Backoff is the fixed schedule in Section 3.3.

5.4 Bound violations and server deduplication

These stress results use every-tick queries. They must not be pooled with the main cases.

Bound violation	Rule	Cases	Duplicates	Clean confirmations	Deadline stops
Delay 12	No retry	16	0	8	8
Delay 12	Bound 12	16	3	6	7
Delay 12	Terminal status	16	0	9	7
Read lag 8	No retry	64	0	32	32
Read lag 8	Bound 12	64	4	40	20
Read lag 8	Terminal status	64	0	41	23

The 12-tick rule creates three duplicates in the late-execution suite and four in the stale-read suite. The terminal rule creates none. However, it confirms only 9 of 16 and 41 of 64 cases before the deadline. Safety does not imply timely completion. The full schedule results are retained even when they are worse.

Under ideal server deduplication, no policy produces a duplicate in any of the 6,720 matched runs. This confirms the intended positive control. It does not demonstrate an implemented or universal exactly-once service. H4 holds under the stated truthful-status and deduplication contracts.

6. Real agent and browser pilot

6.1 Saved design and executed task

We added a controlled browser pilot after the synthetic study. The new plan and configuration were saved before implementation and scored execution. The implementation was hashed before the warm-up and scored trials. The original synthetic results remain unchanged. See browser_plan.md, browser_plan_manifest.json, and browser_execution_manifest.json.

Two separate Codex agent contexts used Chrome through the supported computer-use interface. Each context received nine trials in a fixed order. Runner B used the reverse policy-condition order of runner A. The agents read the rendered accessibility or DOM state and used visible buttons. The runners were instructed to select each next action in a separate model decision and not use a scripted policy loop. The saved logs record actions and states, but do not contain model-turn boundaries or tool code. Thus, those logs cannot alone prove every access or decision constraint. This is a real agent interaction test with an artificial local task. It is not a pixel-only benchmark or a public-web evaluation.

The task was to create exactly one stored item. A local Python HTTP server accepted submissions. Independent timers then committed or permanently dropped each attempt. Each commit inserted a row into SQLite. A requested state check showed the item count and first-attempt status at a configured historical time. That snapshot did not update by itself. The agent could submit, request state, claim completion, or stop. The app enforced a maximum of two submissions. It did not enforce the policy-specific retry or claim rules. The state fields were structured and truthful by construction.

Condition	Initial attempt	Retry if sent	Read lag
Pending	Commit after 16 seconds	Commit after 2 seconds	0 seconds
Failure	Permanently drop after 4 seconds	Commit after 2 seconds	0 seconds
Stale	Commit after 4 seconds	Commit after 2 seconds	8 seconds

These are nominal timer delays. The evidence records actual resolution times. Three rules each had two runs per condition, for 18 assigned trials. Absence retried after the first requested empty state. Bound24 required a newly requested empty state at elapsed time 24 seconds or later. Terminal required a requested empty state with permanent failure status. All rules allowed one retry at most.

The 24-second threshold adds the largest nominal action delay and largest read lag. It is conservative for these selected combinations. It is not the fastest possible safe timeout.

A requested count of one permitted a completion claim before the 60-second deadline. A count of two required a duplicate stop. A state check at or after 60 seconds required an unresolved stop. A late claim was retained but could not count as a clean on-time confirmation. Pending actions continued after every stop. Final stored rows, not the stop screen, determined duplicate outcomes.

The runner prompts hid condition labels, delay values, outcomes, source code, and audit data. The runners were told not to inspect those data or the other runner. They shared one machine and browser service, so this was instruction-based separation, not a secure isolation boundary. The lead did one excluded warm-up trial. The fixed budget allowed new scored trials for 12 minutes after the first scored submission. There was no replacement of an inconvenient trial.

6.2 Measurements and limits of comparison

The primary measures were final duplicates, clean on-time claims, unsafe claims, and adherence to the supplied rule. An unsafe claim is any completion claim whose final item count is not one. The server used a monotonic clock for all measured elapsed seconds. Browser and model overhead contributed to these times. The study did not measure their parts separately.

We retained each browser action log, requested snapshot, server event, durable record, and stopped-trial screenshot. The final audit waited for all accepted attempts to resolve. A negative observation was called stale when a committed record already existed at the observation request time but was absent from its historical snapshot. An unresolved-negative exposure was an empty observation made before the initial attempt resolved. A pending-status exposure could also come from a delayed historical snapshot. These are test exposures, not model mistakes by themselves.

The saved hypotheses asked whether absence could create duplicates, whether terminal could avoid them and recover earlier than Bound24, and whether the final audit could find a duplicate after a completion claim. All assigned trials remain in the results. Timing comparisons pair the same runner and condition where both policies have clean on-time claims. Two repetitions per cell do not support a population error rate, a safety certificate, or a statistical significance claim. We do not combine these seconds or counts with the synthetic grid.

6.3 Observed results

All 18 assigned trials started and stopped. The frozen evidence contains 380 server events, 23 stored rows including the excluded warm-up, and 62 requested snapshots including the warm-up. The scored trials used 28 accepted submissions and 61 snapshots. The browser reported Chrome 155.0.0.0 on macOS. The server used CPython 3.14.7. The exact immutable agent model build was not available. See browser_environment.json.

Rule	Trials	Duplicates	Clean on-time claims	Unsafe claims	Deadline misses	Snapshots
Absence	6	4	1	4	1	13
Bound24	6	0	5	0	1	30
Terminal	6	0	5	0	1	18

Deadline misses include unresolved stops and late completion claims. Absence had one unresolved stop. Bound24 had one unresolved stop. Terminal had one late claim. The four duplicates came from both pending and both stale-condition absence trials. Three had an empty observation before a later original commit. All three created duplicates, which meets the narrow H-B1 criterion. The fourth, A09, saw an empty historical state after the original record already existed. It also created a duplicate. Thus both unresolved execution and delayed visibility were active in the observed failures. All four false completion claims were allowed by the deliberately weak absence rule. They are not evidence that an unconstrained agent would naturally choose that rule.

A01 gives a measured example with no configured read lag. The first empty check occurred at 4.091 seconds. The agent submitted a retry at 7.087 seconds. That retry committed at 9.097 seconds. A check at 12.560 seconds showed one item while the original attempt remained pending. The original attempt committed at 16.008 seconds. The completion claim arrived at 16.244 seconds and referred to the earlier one-item snapshot. The final database held two items. The other three duplicate trials also had two stored items before the claim reached the server. There were no post-stop effects and no duplicate created after a claim. H-B3 therefore had zero observed instances. The pilot does not reproduce the synthetic study's later-after-stop duplicate trace.

Bound24 and Terminal each had five clean on-time claims and no duplicates. Terminal used 18 snapshots, versus 30 for Bound24, across six assigned trials each. These are observed call totals. Different delays, interrupted contexts, and outcome sets prevent a causal efficiency claim. The server-visible rule checks passed in 17 trials. A04 made a late terminal-policy claim at 69.230 seconds after reading a one-item snapshot requested at 20.076 seconds. Its final count was one, but it failed the on-time criterion. This is a deadline failure, not a duplicate failure.

The agent logs report context recovery or compaction delays in A02, A04, B05, and B07. A02 stopped unresolved at 93.147 seconds. B05 stopped unresolved at 68.737 seconds. Both had one final item. B07's first check arrived at 49.340 seconds; its clean claim arrived at 52.488 seconds. Repeated Statsig telemetry HTTP 403 notices appeared in both runner logs. The saved task requests reached the local server. The study cannot isolate how much time came from telemetry, model inference, tool work, context recovery, or shared host load. No trial was removed or repeated.

6.4 Paired timing results

The table preserves all six planned pairs. The difference is Terminal minus Bound24, so a negative value means the terminal trial was faster. A difference is given only when both trials were clean and on time. All values are measured seconds.

Runner and condition	Bound24 claim	Terminal claim	Paired difference	Pair status
A, failure	None	17.789	Not compared	Bound24 unresolved
A, pending	25.488	69.230	Not compared	Terminal late
A, stale	21.268	16.529	-4.739	Both clean
B, failure	37.583	22.092	-15.491	Both clean
B, pending	21.599	23.272	+1.673	Both clean
B, stale	15.364	52.488	+37.124	Both clean

The four matched differences range from -15.491 to +37.124 seconds. Their median is -1.533 seconds and mean is +4.642 seconds. Terminal is faster in two pairs and slower in two. Only the B failure pair is clean under both rules. In that pair, Terminal confirms 15.491 seconds earlier than Bound24. The A failure pair is not a valid speed comparison because Bound24 has no completion claim. H-B2 supports zero duplicates under the tested truthful-status contract, but these browser data do not establish a general speed gain. In particular, the synthetic 22.81% reduction must not be presented as a browser measurement.

No trial breached the selected 24-second first-resolution-plus-lag threshold. The largest timer overrun above its nominal scheduled delay was 0.012 seconds. Nominal timer values were not exact real-time guarantees. The saved raw times retain full precision. The 60-second claim deadline and tool delay had larger effects on clean completion than these small scheduling overruns.

The full trial table, all six pairs, and evidence checks are in browser_results.csv, browser_pairs.csv, and browser_summary.json. The pilot supports the specific duplicate-risk mechanism and shows a

separate deadline problem. It does not establish field error rates, natural agent behavior, or universal safe retry timing.

7. Live test-site experiment: check the scope of a view

7.1 Question, plan, and site selection

A **view scope** is the set of records that a page can show under its current filters. A Completed task view excludes active tasks by design. Its empty result can be current and correct even after an active task was created. This cause differs from the delayed writes and old snapshots in Sections 3 and 6.

The question is whether a fresh check or a 24-second wait prevents duplicate entries under an incomplete view. A second question asks whether changing to the All view can confirm one task without a retry. The contribution is a saved small comparison of supplied procedures. Checking filters and reconciling records are established ideas; the experiment is not a new general retry protocol.

The fixed design assigns 60 trials: two hosted implementations, two starting views, five rules, and three repeat blocks. The sites are official KnockoutJS TodoMVC and Microsoft's TodoMVC demo. They are external live websites built for tests. They implement one related workflow. They are not two independent production application domains.

The initial plan was saved before warm-up. The final plan was amended before all scored trials. UI Testing Playground failed a certificate check and was excluded. The official React and Vue apps each showed a warm-up item that disappeared after reload. KnockoutJS had an initial input action with no created row, then passed a separate warm-up. The Microsoft demo also passed its reload check. These failed setup checks remain in live_preflight.md. Site selection therefore favors apps that passed a small feasibility check. The amended plan and hash record are live_plan.md and live_plan_manifest.json. These are local records, not external preregistration.

7.2 Procedures and measures

Each task requests exactly one active item with a unique token. One agent context uses each origin in one active write tab. The browser is reloaded before each trial, and the view is set to All or Completed. The token must have no visible match before submission. The fixed assignment file uses a cyclic rule order and alternating view order across three blocks. There is no random sampling. The two contexts share the host and browser service.

Rule	Procedure after a fresh zero-match view
No retry	Stop unresolved without another submission.
Absence	Submit the same token once more, inspect, and stop.
Wait24	Inspect at or after 24 seconds; retry once only if still zero.
Closure	Retry only after an attempt-specific guarantee of no future effect; otherwise stop unresolved.
Scope	Select All and inspect again. Confirm one match. Without a match or a closure signal, stop unresolved.

The 24 seconds are a chosen heuristic. They are not a proved bound for either website. Neither app provides the required terminal-failure signal. Closure and No retry therefore have the same permitted retry behavior here. This is not a test of successful terminal-failure recovery.

Only Scope can change the filter during its decision phase. All controls are visible to every rule. This tests prescribed procedures with different evidence use. An unconstrained agent could already inspect the filter, and need not make the mistakes that Absence is instructed to make. The 60-second decision deadline starts with the initial submit request. At most one retry is allowed. Each runner has a 20-minute trial admission budget. No failed or late trial is replaced.

The runner stops with success only when it observes exactly one matching visible task. The later audit selects All, counts exact token matches, reloads, and counts again. It checks that the task remains active. An audit cannot repair the earlier decision. A **clean confirmed success** requires an on-time success decision and exactly one active task after reload. A **duplicate** means two or more matching task entries after reload. Pre-reload duplicates, reload loss, unresolved decisions, errors, and rule deviations are separate measures.

The observations come from rendered page content and accessibility information through the supported browser tool. The test is not pixel-only. The audit uses the same UI and browser service; it is not an independent server audit. Reload survival means retention in this browser at that check. It does not prove server storage or indefinite durability. The runners were instructed not to read app source, storage APIs, or hidden browser state. This was an instruction boundary, not a secure access boundary. Source inspection by a separate design reviewer did not supply task outcomes.

The saved plan defines three directional checks: more duplicates for Absence and Wait24 in Completed view; more clean confirmations for Scope than Closure on both sites; and All-view success without retries as a positive control. Report all cells rather than a population significance claim. Repeated tasks in two related apps do not justify field error rates or independent-trial confidence intervals. Measured time includes model, tool, and host delay. Timing comparisons are descriptive and exploratory.

7.3 Results

All 60 assigned trials started, stopped, and received both audits. There were 29 clean confirmed successes and 31 unresolved decisions. The final audits found 40 single-task outcomes, 10 duplicate outcomes, and 10 zero-task outcomes. All matching tasks were active. The counts before and after reload agreed in every scored trial. Thus the ten zero outcomes were not observed losses across reload: each was already zero in the full-list audit before reload.

Rule	View	Trials	Clean confirmed	Duplicates	No task	Retries
No retry	All	6	4	0	2	0
No retry	Completed	6	0	0	1	0
Absence	All	6	6	0	0	2
Absence	Completed	6	0	5	0	6
Wait24	All	6	6	0	0	2
Wait24	Completed	6	0	5	0	6
Closure	All	6	5	0	1	0
Closure	Completed	6	0	0	2	0
Scope	All	6	4	0	2	0
Scope	Completed	6	4	0	2	0

No task means zero matching task entries after reload. A single item found only by the audit does not count as a clean confirmation. Of the 31 unresolved decisions, 11 had one task, 10 had two tasks, and 10 had no task. All ten duplicate trials stopped unresolved while the Completed view still hid both active items. No success decision had a duplicate or zero final audit count.

The Microsoft demo had 18 clean confirmations, six duplicate outcomes, and no zero-task outcomes in 30 trials. KnockoutJS had 11 clean confirmations, four duplicate outcomes, and ten zero-task outcomes in 30 trials. Its input still contained the token after 16 initial submission actions. Six of these trials later had one task after their permitted retry; ten had none. The logs show input text retention and

missing task rows. They do not isolate a cause in the application, input event path, or tool. No claim of a lost server write follows from this observation.

H1 met its saved direction on both sites. In Completed view, Absence and Wait24 each created three duplicates in three Microsoft trials and two in three KnockoutJS trials. Closure and Scope created none. A 24-second wait did not remove the effect of the filter.

H2 also met its direction on both sites. In Completed view, Scope made three clean confirmations in three Microsoft trials and one in three KnockoutJS trials. Closure made none on either site. The two remaining Scope trials had no task before or after reload and stopped unresolved. The scope check confirmed an existing task; it did not recover those missing submissions.

H3 did not meet its criterion. Only 21 of 30 All-view trials confirmed a new task without a retry. All nine failures of this control occurred on KnockoutJS. Four later recovered with their permitted retry, so the All-view group had 25 clean confirmations in total. The other five ended with no task. This failed control limits a causal comparison of overall success counts across rules and sites.

There were 16 retries: eight under Absence and eight under Wait24. Every retry had an eligible empty observation. The analyzer found no scored tool error, policy deviation, or late decision. The largest decision interval was 44.431 seconds. These are wall times through the model and browser service, not website latency. The study does not claim that Scope is faster or that Wait24 is an efficient timeout.

Both runners had setup errors when they tried to use tabs owned by the parent session. They then opened their own tabs before scoring. Three T result records have a start time one millisecond before the action log's start time, from two clock reads. A diagnostic clock record during T06 had a stale T01 label; its later correction remains in the raw log. The analyzer excludes that clock-only record from trial actions. It keeps both start times and obtains the same result for all 60 deadline checks and all eight Wait24 checks under either time. No raw record was removed or rewritten to hide a failed test.

The package retains 302 scored UI observations, 428 scored action records, and 60 audit screenshots. An action record can contain several deterministic tool operations; it is not a token count or model-call count. The installed Chrome app version was 155.0.8059.40 on macOS. The exact immutable model build and provider inference hardware were unavailable. See live_results.csv, live_summary.json, live_pairs.csv, and live_environment.json.

7.4 Interpretation

The live test adds a distinct boundary to the earlier timing result. A current empty list does not prove absence if its filter excludes the requested record. Waiting longer does not change that scope. In the tested Completed view, a full-list check confirmed four existing tasks without a repeat submission. This is the supported improvement.

The scope rule was not uniformly successful: it had four zero-task outcomes across both views. The failed All controls show why a reliable create action must also be checked. The experiment does not identify the cause of the input failures. A future study can separate input delivery, page readiness, and task creation, with the checks fixed before data collection.

These results concern two related hosted test apps and instructed procedures. They do not show that a free-choice agent would ignore an obvious Completed filter. They do not test a server transaction, an uncertain network commit, or a production terminal-status service. Closure and No retry have the same available retry actions here, so their small difference in clean counts cannot establish a benefit of terminal status. Keep these results separate from the local delayed-write pilot and the synthetic event model.

8. Authenticated account experiment: a live service can change the view

8.1 Question and saved design

The user next authorized temporary test records in connected accounts. We added a separate Google Drive experiment. It asks whether the public-demo result transfers to one real authenticated service. It also checks whether an exact-name creation message can support confirmation when the list is filtered. The previous 60 trials remain unchanged and are not pooled with these results.

The lead created a new private parent folder and four private block folders. Connector metadata reported that the parent was not shared and had one owner permission. Each trial requests one new empty folder with a unique synthetic name. No existing user file is a test record. The app is a real service; the chosen task remains a constructed, low-impact workflow. Google documents file-type filters, and its API permits nonunique names within one folder [12,13]. Distinct record IDs, rather than names alone, identify duplicate creations.

The saved design has 24 core trials: Absence, Wait24, and Scope in All and Documents views, each repeated four times. Six Receipt controls use three repeats per view. Rules rotate across four fixed blocks, and the view order alternates. Two new Codex contexts use disjoint blocks in the same account and browser service. There is no random sample or seed. The plan, assignments, and plan hash were saved before all scored actions. The unequal Receipt repeat count is explicit.

The plan followed two excluded feasibility creations. The first immediate view kept Documents and displayed Working. A later reload exposed the folder. A separate connector read confirmed the record. A second creation checked duplicate names. This small setup check did not establish how long the filter would remain. It is not external preregistration.

8.2 Procedures, observations, and audit

All has no type filter. Documents excludes folders. The plan requires the runner to set the assigned view and verify that the token is absent before each trial. After Create, it saves the immediate state. At the next model decision, it takes a fresh state. The core rules use exact matching folder rows only. Absence repeats once after a zero count. Wait24 makes a fresh check at or after 24 seconds and repeats once if still zero. Scope removes the type filter after a zero count and checks the complete block; it does not repeat a write. All rules can confirm one matching visible row. Two or more rows require an unresolved stop.

The Receipt control submits once. It can confirm one visible row or a positive creation message that names the exact token. Generic success or Working text is insufficient. If neither is present, it makes fresh checks at or after 8, 16, and 24 seconds, then stops unresolved. It does not change the filter or repeat a write. Notifications remain in the logs for all rules. Thus the core rules are restricted procedures, not a test of what an unconstrained agent would infer from the complete screen.

The 120-second deadline starts at the first Create click request. It allows more modal steps than the previous single-input task. Time includes model and tool overhead. Each context has a 30-minute admission budget. No failed trial can be replaced. No network fault, response delay, or forged status is introduced. If the site changes a filter, the runner records the observed view and does not restore the assigned filter during the decision. The assigned view and actual first-decision view are separate fields.

After each stop, a browser audit checks the full block list and removes the filter if needed. It counts matching rows, reloads, and counts again. After both runners finish, a separate connected Drive tool lists each block. A duplicate is two or more distinct returned IDs for a token. A clean confirmation requires a confirmation within the deadline and exactly one connector record. The audit cannot repair the earlier decision. This is a finite service-backed read; it does not prove indefinite durability, internal transaction semantics, or permanent execution closure.

The plan defines H-A1 as more Documents duplicates under each list-only retry rule than Scope. H-A2 requires more Scope confirmations in Documents with no added duplicates. H-A3 requires every All core control to confirm exactly one record without a retry. Receipt is a descriptive control. Few ordered trials in one account do not justify population error intervals or p-values.

8.3 Results

All 30 assigned trials finished. Each first decision saw one matching folder row and an exact-name creation message. All decisions were within 120 seconds. Browser counts before and after reload agreed with the later connector audit for all 30 tokens. The connector returned 30 distinct record IDs: one per token, with no unexpected records. It read four blocks with 8, 8, 8, and 6 records, below its requested capacity of 100 per block. These counts are separate from the earlier 60 public-site trials.

Rule	Assigned All: clean / trials	Assigned Documents: clean / trials	Duplicate outcomes	Retries
Absence	4 / 4	4 / 4	0	0
Wait24	4 / 4	4 / 4	0	0
Scope	4 / 4	4 / 4	0	0
Receipt control	3 / 3	3 / 3	0	0

The intended hidden-folder condition did not remain effective at the decision. All 15 assigned Documents trials showed the folder. Only one first-decision state explicitly showed All in the filter toolbar. The other 14 did not show the toolbar, so its exact filter state is recorded as not shown. A visible folder establishes that the decision view did not hide that folder. It does not prove the exact time or internal cause of a filter change. The immediate and later views differ; the supplied Scope rule did not cause that change.

No retry, scheduled wait, or rule-driven filter removal occurred. H-A1 and H-A2 do not meet their positive-difference criteria: all relevant duplicate and clean-confirmation differences are zero. The experiment does not identify their effect under a stable hidden view. H-A3 passes in all 12 All core controls. All six Receipt controls also pass, but their matching rows were already visible. Thus these trials do not show a benefit from the receipt alone.

Decision time has a median of 7.810 seconds and a range of 6.333 to 15.028 seconds. This is time from the first Create click request to the recorded decision. It includes model and tool delay; it is not service latency or a measured retry speed gain. All 24 core comparisons within the same block and assigned view have equal clean and duplicate outcomes. Their timing differences are descriptive only.

The saved evidence has defects. D02 and D06 show the assigned filter before Create, but neither has a usable list or an explicit empty-result message before the write. These two absence checks are unverified plan deviations. The other 28 have a verified baseline. All 30 remain in the outcome table. Dropping the two deviations is not needed to interpret the null retry exposure: no other trial reaches a retry condition either.

A logger kept old labels in D01 and the early B records. Explicit corrections use the recorded action time, unique creation token, and line ranges. The original text records and invalid earlier exports remain available in redacted form. They are not silently replaced. Three original images, D11-D13, were overwritten; the file named D11 instead shows D14. No later image is treated as their original evidence. D16 and D18 each have one failed browser audit read after the decision. Later ready reads show one row. No extra write followed either error.

See account_results.csv, account_pairs.csv, account_summary.json, and account_connector_audit.json. Four later block images show all test rows after the trial decisions. They support the final count only. The evidence notes describe their times, privacy limits, and missing original images.

8.4 Interpretation and limits

This is a negative transfer result for the planned comparison. The live public task apps kept a view that hid newly created tasks. In the account experiment, the first decision already exposed each new folder. All rules then used the same positive evidence. Zero duplicates under this condition do not show that an absence-based retry is safe when the result remains hidden. More successful repetitions of the same path would not supply the missing retry exposure.

The useful result is an evaluation requirement: check the actual decision state after the action. An assigned filter alone does not establish the intended condition. Record visible rows and receipts separately from filter labels. Before a future retry comparison, a feasibility test must establish that a permitted real workflow retains the relevant negative view through the agent's decision. This study does not modify the site or reapply the filter to force that result after observation.

The method uses visible browser state and accessibility text, not pixels alone. Runners were instructed not to inspect application source, storage, network traffic, or connector data during decisions. This is an instruction boundary rather than secure isolation. Complete tool-call code and model-turn boundaries are not independently captured by the saved action summaries. The later connector audit is not evidence that the runner had server knowledge at its decision time.

Public logs retain test rows, filters, notifications, actions, and timing. Private account identifiers and navigation details are removed through the documented redaction process. Original logs and full images remain local. Stable pseudonyms preserve distinct connector IDs. Other accounts and workflows may behave differently. A new run can change because service code, account settings, model behavior, and tool timing can change.

9. Two-tab account experiment: test rules when the result stays hidden

9.1 Question, selection, and saved plan

The earlier account experiment did not activate retry rules. This extension asks a narrower question: can a separate observer tab keep a real folder outside its list and cause the supplied rules to take different actions? The writer creates one folder in All. The observer checks the same block with either All or Documents. The task uses normal Google Drive controls. No fault or delay is injected into the service. No hidden state change or false status is introduced.

Three excluded feasibility cases established the workflow. P01 kept the Documents view empty after creation and reload at 17.099 seconds. A progress message had incorrectly called this a 24-second check; the saved clock record corrected it before scored trials. P02 showed its folder in a ready All view after reload. P03 kept Documents empty at 9.389 and 72.973 seconds, then showed one folder in All at 88.967 seconds. These times include other task work, so they are not service-delay measurements. The preflight record preserves all three cases and the correction.

The workflow was selected because it exposes the stated condition. It is not a random sample of websites or ordinary user tasks. The plan, assignments, runner instructions, and manifest were frozen before scored writes. Local hashes are not external preregistration. The first incorrect draft remains available. The source search distinguishes this addition from prior reliability work and limits the novelty claim.

There are 32 assignments: four rules, two observer views, and four repeats per cell. Four blocks each contain every rule-view pair once. Two separate Codex contexts each run two blocks. A fixed seed of 20261015 controls assignment order only. The contexts share one account, host, and browser service. The same two-tab arrangement and first reload procedure apply to all rules. All trials remain in the primary table, including errors or absent triggers. No replacement or extra trial is allowed to meet an outcome target.

9.2 Procedure and decision evidence

Both tabs start in the same block. The writer is in All. The observer has its assigned view. A usable baseline must show an enabled New control, an explicit filter state, and a readable list or explicit empty view. Loading is unknown, not zero. Each trial has a unique exact folder name. The writer submits this name through New, New folder, and Create. The first Create request starts a 120-second decision deadline.

The runner saves the writer feedback, reloads the observer, and reads until the view is ready. It counts only exact-name folder rows. The three core rules are deliberately restricted to observer rows. The model can see writer feedback while it operates the tab, but cannot use that feedback to confirm under these rules. This is a supplied information rule, not a test of an agent acting without such limits.

Rule	Action after a ready zero in the observer
Absence	Create the same folder name once more; reload and check the observer.
Wait24	At or after 24 seconds from the first request, reload and check again. Repeat the write once only if that new ready count is zero.
Scope	If Documents is active, remove it, reload All, and check. Never repeat the write.
Receipt	Use the exact current-name writer success message, with one fresh writer read if needed. Never repeat the write or change the observer filter.

One observer row can confirm completion. Two or more require an unresolved stop. A post-retry zero remains unresolved. Receipt can confirm from its exact-name success message while the observer is zero; a generic message is insufficient. No rule may write after the deadline. The 24-second wait is a chosen heuristic, not a service completion bound. Scope preserves the earlier no-retry rule. Receipt has one optional fresh writer check, which differs from the earlier same-tab control's 8/16/24-second schedule. These experiments are not pooled.

The runner saves its decision before any audit. Then it removes the observer filter, reloads All, and records matching rows and a separate image. After every trial ends, the lead lists each block through a separate Drive connector. A duplicate requires at least two distinct returned record IDs for one token. A clean confirmation requires an on-time confirmation and exactly one audited record. A later audit cannot turn an unresolved decision into a confirmation. This audit is a finite record read; it cannot establish indefinite durability or execution closure.

H-T1 requires more Documents duplicate outcomes under each retry rule than Scope. H-T2 requires more clean Documents confirmations under Scope than each retry rule, with no extra duplicates. H-T3 requires all 16 All controls to confirm one record without a retry. The activation check is separate: actual Absence and Wait24 retries, a Scope change to All, and a Receipt confirmation from its message while the observer is zero must each occur at least once in Documents. This check cannot change the sample size. Counts and full paths are used without population confidence intervals or significance tests.

9.3 Results

All 32 assignments were retained. The logs contain 42 Create tool requests: 41 returned without a tool error and one failed. A successful tool call is not itself proof of a stored record. The later connector audit returned 41 distinct records across the four blocks, with 10, 11, 10, and 10 records. Exact-name counts agreed with all 32 final browser audits. No unexpected token or shared test record was found.

A **duplicate case** has two or more audited records for its one assigned token. A **false confirmation** is a completion claim with a final count other than one. These outcome columns can overlap: T31 is both a duplicate case and a false confirmation.

Rule	Observer view	Trials	Retries	Duplicate cases	Clean confirmations	Unresolved	False confirmations
Absence	All	4	3	3	1	2	1
Absence	Documents	4	4	4	0	4	0
Wait24	All	4	0	0	4	0	0
Wait24	Documents	4	3	3	0	4	0
Scope	All	4	0	0	3	1	0
Scope	Documents	4	0	0	4	0	0
Receipt	All	4	0	0	4	0	0
Receipt	Documents	4	0	0	3	1	0
Total	Both	32	10	10	19	12	1

All four required Documents branches occurred: four Absence retries, three Wait24 retries, four Scope changes, and three Receipt confirmations from the exact writer message while the observer showed zero. Each of the ten actual retries was followed by a two-record audit. The observations satisfy H-T1 and H-T2 within this selected set. They fail H-T3: only 12 of 16 All controls cleanly confirmed without retry. Nine All controls had a first ready zero. Thus, All did not provide immediate complete visibility in this run.

T31 is the false confirmation. Absence saw zero, repeated Create, then confirmed from a one-row text observation. The later image and both final audits showed two. The evidence establishes a wrong completion claim relative to the later audit. It does not establish the exact order of server completion and list updates.

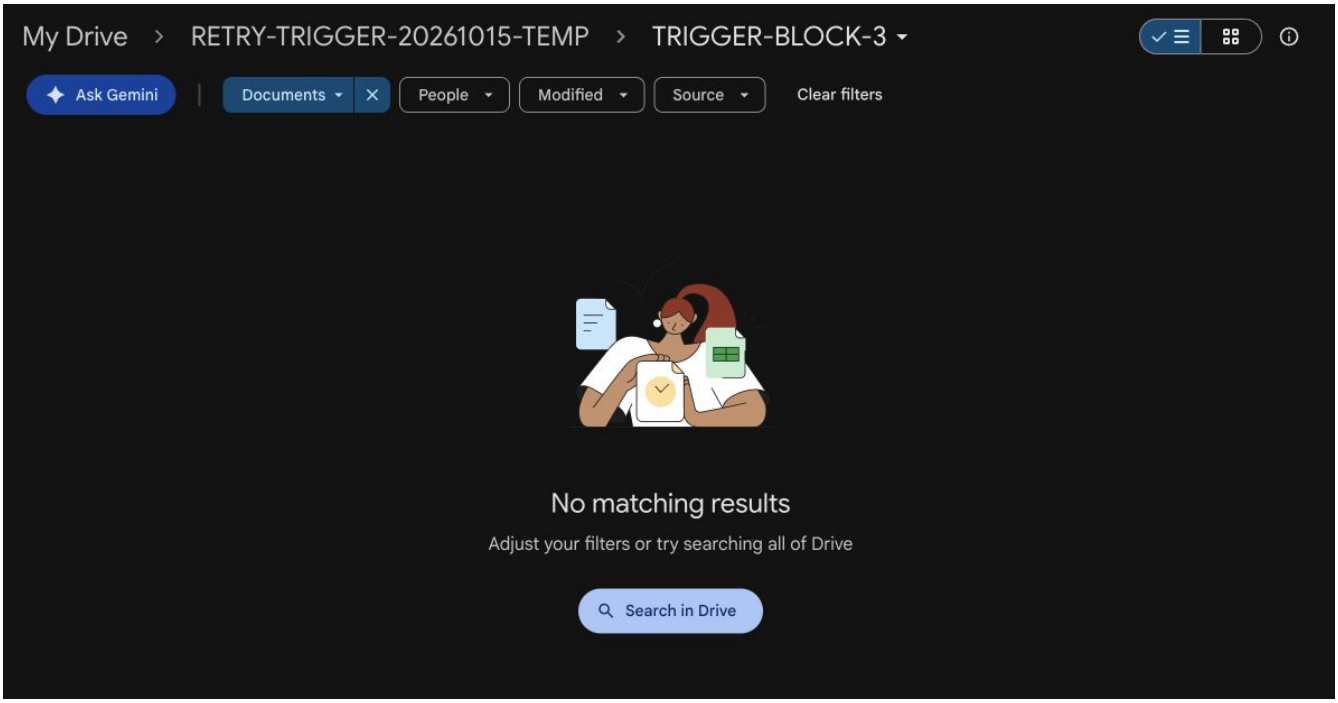
T07, a Wait24/Documents assignment, included an extra reload at 22.302 seconds. This was too early and was excluded from retry permission. The eligible reload started at 34.053 seconds. Its ready zero arrived at 108.478 seconds. The runner prepared a retry dialog, checked the deadline at 121.567 seconds, and did not press Create again. It saved an unresolved decision at 131.539 seconds, after the deadline, then closed the dialog. The final audit found one record. This case is retained as an activation failure and a late unresolved decision.

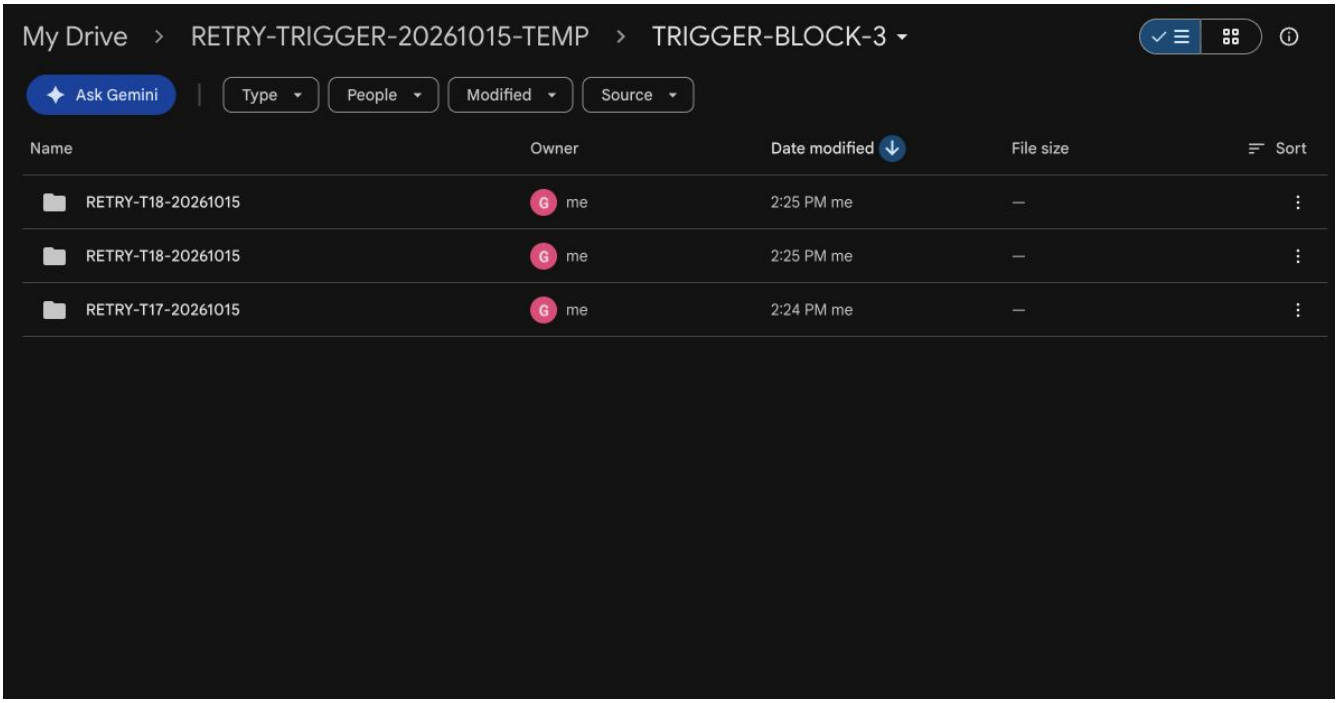
T29, a Receipt/Documents assignment, started with a valid baseline. After the New folder action, the writer was on an unrelated Storage view. The later input and Create calls failed. There was no success receipt, and the observer and final audits showed zero. This is one failed Create request, not a successful write with a lost result. The cause of the navigation is unknown. The next trial, T30, restored its exact block URL and verified both baselines before its first write. No scored trial was replaced.

T13 had a menu-action timeout even though the menu opened, plus an observer read error followed by a fresh read. These errors remain in the logs. The median recorded decision time was 19.771 seconds, with a range of 8.820 to 131.539 seconds. Timing includes model, tool, browser, and shared-host work; it does not measure service latency or establish a speed advantage.

The saved text decision and later decision image differ in T04, T24, and T27 (zero then one), and T31 (one then two). T10's later decision image is blank in the task area and is unknown evidence. Images were captured after the decisions. They cannot replace the earlier text or change its score. All final audit images support their recorded counts.

See trial results, cell totals, analysis record, and service audit. The image archive contains 64 original clipped images. Its original `.png` filenames contain JPEG bytes; the manifest records this format. One separate full-screen diagnostic image is excluded to protect account details.





These two images show the T18 decision view and its later audit. They are Google Drive UI evidence. The clipped area keeps the test path, filter, and result rows. It excludes account details and unrelated navigation. The audit image cannot support the earlier decision.

9.4 Interpretation and limits

The supplied immediate and timed retry rules took their repeat-action branches on a real service. All ten repeat actions were associated with duplicate records at audit. This shows that these branch conditions were insufficient in this selected workflow. It does not estimate how often an unrestricted agent would repeat an action or how often a normal user task would fail.

Scope and Receipt each avoided repeats. Scope had seven clean confirmations in eight assignments; Receipt also had seven. Their different unresolved cases matter: Scope/All T27 stopped on a zero that later became one, while Receipt/Documents T29 failed before a record was created. These are not equivalent successful outcomes. No rule achieved all clean confirmations.

The All controls limit causal interpretation. A ready unfiltered list sometimes showed zero, so the Documents filter alone cannot explain every negative read or duplicate. A browser reload did not guarantee that all effects were visible at once. The design changes view scope under a shared two-tab workflow, but it does not isolate cache delay, service delay, rendering delay, scheduling, or other host activity. T29 and T30 also show an unresolved workflow-state failure. We do not attribute that failure to a particular service or tool defect.

The contribution is a complete, reproducible record of this selected branch test, including unsuccessful triggers, a false confirmation, and audit disagreement with earlier observations. It does not introduce a new retry rule. Both runner contexts knew the supplied procedures and could see feedback that three rules were instructed to ignore. This is not blind evaluation, a held-out task set, or an estimate of model ability. Four trials per cell, one account, one folder task, and shared execution context do not support population confidence intervals or a claim of general reliability.

The final connector audit is separate from the browser decision path, but it is still a finite service read. It cannot establish that a record will persist indefinitely or that no future effect is possible. An exact success message was useful in the completed Receipt cases; these results do not prove that every success message is durable or correctly tied to an attempt. The change record and redaction record preserve the limits of the public evidence.

10. Additional website experiment: temporary tables

10.1 Question, selection, and saved plan

We next test the same view-scope mechanism on two more real websites: ToolsQA DemoQA Web Tables and SpryMedia's official DataTables Add rows example [15-17]. Both are public hosted demonstrations. They are not additional authenticated production services. The question is whether the supplied rules create extra rows when ordinary search hides the first result. Earlier studies remain separate.

Excluded feasibility checks selected the sites. DemoQA kept the test row hidden at 30.611 seconds. DataTables' first later read occurred at 19.606 seconds and failed the 24-second timing check. A second feasibility case kept the row hidden at 36.318 seconds. Both sites accepted a second Add operation and restored their default rows after reload. All cases, including the failed timing check, remain in cross_preflight.md and the saved logs. This selection favors tasks that expose the mechanism. It cannot estimate its frequency on the web.

The fixed design has 48 assignments: two sites, three rules, two views, and four repeats per cell. Each site has four blocks of six rule-view pairs. Python random.Random(20261016) shuffled each block in a stated order. The seed controls assignment order only. It does not sample websites or control model generation. The plan, assignments, and runner instructions were saved and hashed before the first scored write. The manifest records the time. This is not external preregistration.

One Codex context operates each site. The contexts share one host and browser service. Site and runner effects cannot be separated. The runners were instructed to make each adaptive choice from new visible browser state. Scripted policy loops were prohibited. A fixed helper can fill the six known form fields and log a selected action. Network faults, injected delays, internal application APIs, browser-storage inspection, and page-state mutation through code were excluded. The logs record browser actions and observations, but not complete model-turn boundaries or tool-call code. This is an instruction boundary, not secure isolation.

10.2 Tasks, rules, and audit

The DemoQA task is to create exactly one row. It uses a unique synthetic first name, TEMP as the last name, a reserved example.com email address, and fixed age, salary, and department values. A permitted retry repeats all six fields. Two exact-token rows are duplicate records. The default three example records remain unchanged.

The DataTables task is to add exactly one new row. The UI chooses each five-cell row vector; a vector is an ordered list of cell values. A fresh page starts with one baseline vector. The audit counts vectors absent from that baseline. A second Add creates another generated row. This is an extra effect for a one-row task, but it is not an identical-data duplicate. This difference prevents a claim that both sites test the same record identity.

All means an empty search field. Hidden means the search string CROSS-NOMATCH, set before the first write. The runner records the actual search after the write and does not restore it if the site changes it. A ready view must show the task controls, complete table headers, current search, and disabled Next control. A missing table, open form, read error, or loading state is unknown, not zero. A fresh observation is a new browser read. Reload is forbidden from the initial write through the final audit because it erases these temporary rows.

The deadline is 120 seconds from the first Submit or Add request. One visible target row permits confirmation; two or more require an unresolved stop. After ready zero, Absence repeats the same write once. Wait24 starts another read at least 24 seconds after the initial request and repeats once if that view is still ready zero. Scope clears search after Hidden zero, reads All, and never retries. A retry must start before the deadline. A late claim is not a clean confirmation. The 24-second value is a test heuristic, not a service guarantee.

The three rules use visible target rows. DataTables also shows a total-entry count when search hides rows. The model can see that count, but the supplied rules deliberately ignore it. Thus this test does not measure an unconstrained agent or prove that the whole screen lacks evidence. Neither selected task exposes an established positive receipt tied to an exact current request or record. Receipt is therefore unavailable; form closure is not used as a substitute.

The runner saves its decision before any audit or image capture. It then saves a decision image, clears search, reads the complete table, and saves a separate audit image. That pre-reload audit is the outcome measure. Reload then restores the default rows and empty search; a third image records cleanup. A cleanup zero cannot be used to score the earlier write. No service-side audit or durability guarantee is available.

An extra effect means at least two new task rows before cleanup. A correct confirmation is on time and has exactly one audited row. An unresolved decision stays unresolved even when the later audit shows one. A wrong-count confirmation and a late one-row confirmation are separate errors. Missing evidence remains unknown. H-X1 requires each retry rule to have more Hidden extra effects than Scope, separately for each site. H-X2 requires more correct Hidden confirmations under Scope, with no extra effect. H-X3 requires every All control to confirm one row without retry. There are 12 All controls per site. One failed control rejects H-X3. A separate activation check requires each rule's Hidden branch to occur on each site.

10.3 Results

All 48 assigned trials started, stopped, and received a complete pre-reload audit. There were 32 correct confirmations and 16 unresolved decisions. Every unresolved trial had two new rows at audit. No confirmation had a wrong count or exceeded the deadline. The audits counted 64 new rows in total. All 48 cleanup checks restored the default rows and empty search.

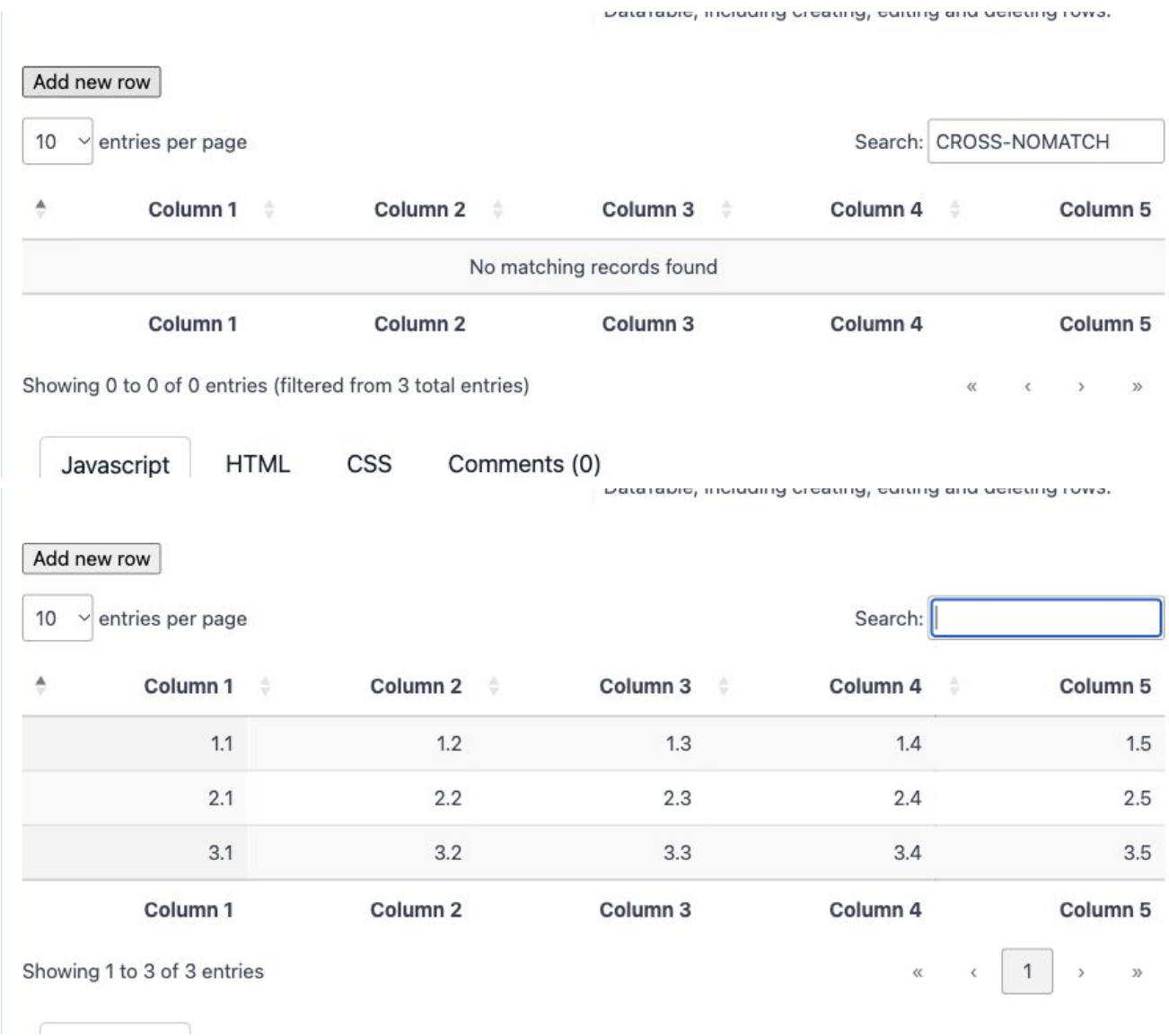
Site	Rule	View	Trials	Extra effects	Correct	Unresolved	Retries
DemoQA	Absence	All	4	0	4	0	0
DemoQA	Absence	Hidden	4	4	0	4	4
DemoQA	Wait24	All	4	0	4	0	0
DemoQA	Wait24	Hidden	4	4	0	4	4
DemoQA	Scope	All	4	0	4	0	0
DemoQA	Scope	Hidden	4	0	4	0	0
DataTables	Absence	All	4	0	4	0	0
DataTables	Absence	Hidden	4	4	0	4	4
DataTables	Wait24	All	4	0	4	0	0
DataTables	Wait24	Hidden	4	4	0	4	4
DataTables	Scope	All	4	0	4	0	0
DataTables	Scope	Hidden	4	0	4	0	0

Each site's four Hidden Absence trials and four Hidden Wait24 trials took the permitted retry. All eight produced extra effects. Each site's four Hidden Scope trials cleared search and confirmed one row without retry. Thus H-X1, H-X2, and all three activation checks hold separately on both sites. H-X3 also holds: all 12 All controls per site confirmed one new row with no retry. These are finite-set outcomes, not estimates of website-wide rates.

The logs contain 48 initial write requests and 16 retry requests. All eight Wait24 later reads began between 27.277 and 29.488 seconds after the first request. Decision time had a median of 6.117 seconds and a range of 2.267 to 40.443 seconds. Timing includes the model, tools, and shared host; it is not website latency or a speed comparison. The analyzer found no scored action error, rule deviation, unverified baseline, or missing audit.

The evidence has one image defect. D03's original audit crop cut part of pagination after the third row appeared. It remains in the archive. A later expanded task image shows all audit rows and controls. A full private fallback image is excluded from the public archive. This image correction did not change D03's unresolved decision or the text audit. Both runners also had a setup-only tab ownership error; DemoQA had an early unbound-helper error before a scored action. These setup failures remain recorded. No scored trial was replaced.

The public package contains 880 scored/setup log records, 272 separate observation records, and 316 chosen UI action records. One action record can include several fixed form fills; it is not a model-call count. The image archive contains 145 JPEG files: 144 planned trial images and D03's additional task image. The image manifest records one excluded full private image. See all trial rows, group counts, summary, evidence notes, and images.



These are DataTables UI observations from D03. The first image follows the saved decision. Its footer has additional evidence that the supplied rules ignore. The second image is the later corrected audit capture; the clipped original remains in the archive. Clearing search exposes the baseline 1.x row and two new vectors, 2.x and 3.x. The images cannot replace earlier text evidence or prove server persistence.

10.4 Interpretation and limits

The new result reproduces the selected search-scope mechanism on two additional public websites. A new browser read can be current and still show no relevant row because search hides it. Waiting at least 24 seconds did not remove that search condition. Clearing search exposed the existing effect and avoided the repeat action in these cases.

The extra effects have different identities. DemoQA has duplicate named records. DataTables has two different generated rows for a task that requested one. Both are task over-execution, but they are not the same duplicate-key behavior. No claim about server transaction semantics follows.

Unlike the earlier TodoMVC and two-tab Drive studies, every All control passed in this selected set. That result supports the local comparison under these specific conditions. It does not cancel earlier failed controls or establish a general reliability gain. The sites were selected for stable search behavior, use similar table tasks, and share a host and instructed controller setup. Four repeats per cell are not independent samples of natural website use. No population confidence interval or significance claim is made.

The result supports checking search scope before repeating an operation. A full-list positive result can confirm an existing row. An empty full list still cannot prove that an uncertain earlier operation will never finish. Receipt and execution closure were not tested here. The public task pages expose more information than the supplied rules use, including a DataTables total count and visible example documentation. The test is not blind or an unrestricted model benchmark. It measures temporary page effects, with no independent service audit, persistence claim, or speed advantage.

11. Production account experiment: Notion and Google Calendar

11.1 Question and saved design

This extension asks whether the same three supplied rules create duplicate records when a normal production account view excludes a new record. It uses Notion and Google Calendar in the owner's existing signed-in accounts. These are operational services, not demo sites. The tasks and view mismatch are deliberately constructed. The study does not measure naturally occurring outages or the error rate of either service.

The plan was frozen at 2026-10-15 19:36:32.500271 UTC, before scored writes. It assigns 24 trials: two services, three rules, two views, and two repeats per cell. Each service has two blocks of the six rule/view combinations. Python `random.Random(2026101507)` fixes the order in production_assignments.csv. One separate Codex runner owns each service. Both share the host and browser service. The seed controls order only. The plan, runner instructions, and freeze manifest define the task, controls, outcomes, and hypotheses.

Selection used existing access and a safe, reversible task. Dropbox showed a login page and was excluded. No new account, access grant, service purchase, message, or invitation was needed. Notion's documentation describes separate database view filters. Calendar's documentation describes date restrictions in search. Both services document recoverable Trash [18-21]. This is an added transfer test of an established observation-scope mechanism, not a new retry method. The limited source search cannot establish priority. See production_source_notes.md.

Excluded preflights established the task controls and retained failures. A Calendar search submitted with Enter lost its date range; the corrected method commits each date with Tab and clicks the visible-text Search button. A Notion read at 16.883 seconds did not meet the 24-second gate; a later read at 29.505 seconds did. An incomplete Notion render briefly showed a row under Hidden. The frozen readiness test rejects both positive and negative partial renders. These checks did not enter the scored sample.

11.2 Tasks, rules, and evidence

The Notion task creates one page with a unique trial title in a new private database. All is the database's complete table. Hidden has the saved filter `Name contains PROD-NOMATCH`, which excludes every trial title. The writer uses All. The observer uses its assigned view. Scope selects All without changing the saved Hidden filter. The first New click starts the clock because it can create a blank page before title entry. Audits include blank or partly named pages and distinct page identities.

The Calendar task creates one nonrecurring event with a unique title on the primary calendar. The editor uses January 3, 2000, noon to 12:05 pm, Free availability, Private visibility, no guests, no conference, and no notification. The first Save starts the clock. Each retry repeats Create with the same field values. The observer searches the exact title. All covers January 1-31, 2000; Hidden covers January 1-31, 2001. All therefore covers the task date; it is not an account-wide or all-time list. Scope corrects only the date range. The title and calendar stay fixed.

The predeclared deadline is 180 seconds, increased from the earlier 120-second studies to permit the full Calendar form and fresh searches. At most one retry is allowed. After the initial write, every rule reloads the observer and waits for complete task controls. One ready target row permits confirmation. Two or more require an unresolved stop. A loading state or ambiguous view is unknown. After ready zero, Absence repeats once. Wait24 begins another observer reload at least 24 seconds after the first

request and repeats once only if its ready count is still zero. Scope changes Hidden to All and reloads; it never repeats the write. Ready zero already in All makes Scope stop unresolved. The 24-second threshold is a heuristic, not a service guarantee.

The core decisions use only observer rows. Writer feedback, including Calendar's Event saved receipt, remains in the logs but is excluded by instruction. The model is not blind to this evidence. No claim follows that the whole application lacks a useful receipt. The rules and artificial view mismatch are supplied, so this is not an unrestricted agent benchmark or a test of network fault recovery.

The decision is saved before audit or cleanup. A post-decision All reload supplies the browser audit. Calendar also has a bounded read-only connector audit of distinct event IDs and fields, before cleanup. Notion's connector returned HTTP 401 in preflight. Its audit therefore uses complete reloaded browser views and distinct page links, without an independent connector read. Neither finite audit proves indefinite durability or execution closure. Only the created test records are moved to recoverable Trash. Cleanup is checked after reload. No Trash is emptied.

A duplicate has at least two distinct audited exact-title records. A clean confirmation must be on time, have one record with correct task fields, and have no unintended partial record. Count confirmation and full field correctness are separate. Missing evidence stays unknown. H-P1 compares Hidden duplicates for each retry rule with Scope, separately by service. H-P2 compares clean Hidden confirmations. H-P3 requires every All control on a service to confirm one correct record without retry. Branch activation is a separate check. All assignments and failed controls remain in the results.

11.3 Results

All 24 assignments were completed and retained. The audits found 33 distinct exact-title records: 17 Notion pages and 16 Calendar events. Nine trials had duplicate records. Fifteen decisions claimed completion. Fourteen had one audited record; one was a false confirmation with two pages. Nine decisions remained unresolved. Six Notion confirmations met the strict clean definition. Eight one-record Calendar confirmations have unknown time-field correctness. There were no late confirmations. No unintended partial record was observed.

Service	Hidden rule	Trials	Retries	Duplicates	Count confirmations	Strict clean
Google Calendar	Absence	2	2	2	0	0
Google Calendar	Wait24	2	2	2	0	0
Google Calendar	Scope	2	0	0	2	0 known; 2 unknown
Notion	Absence	2	2	2	0	0
Notion	Wait24	2	2	2	0	0
Notion	Scope	2	0	0	2	2

All eight Hidden retry assignments activated their retry branch. Three of the four Hidden Scope assignments had a valid ready-zero trigger. C10 changed scope while a Tasks sidebar loading marker remained, so its strict trigger was not established. The later covered observation still supported its one-record confirmation. Each retry rule had two duplicate cases per service; Scope had none. H-P1 therefore holds for the recorded counts on both services. H-P2 holds for Notion, with the writer-view limits below. It remains unknown for Calendar because strict field correctness is unknown.

Calendar's six All controls each confirmed one audited event without a retry. Their strict correctness remains unknown, so H-P3 is not established. Notion's six All controls had four clean confirmations, one unresolved decision, and one false confirmation after a retry. H-P3 fails for Notion. These control results prevent a filter-only causal claim.

N03 (Scope, All) showed a complete empty table at the decision. It stopped unresolved. The later audit found one page. N12 (Absence, All) first showed a complete table with one blank row and zero exact-title rows. The fixed rule permitted one retry. The final decision view showed one exact-title row and the runner confirmed. The later audit found two rows with distinct page IDs. The first incomplete read, N-00642, is not used; the ready zero is N-00643 and the confirmation evidence is N-00656. A later audit cannot repair either decision.

N04's retry did not establish a ready All writer: its linked state selected Hidden and still showed Side Peek. N05 began creation from Hidden after a writer reload. These are retained procedure departures. Their audits still establish two pages for N04 and one for N05. Other trials also showed a change to Hidden after New despite an earlier All writer observation. These observed changes are separate from a missing ready writer check. Later trials added explicit writer checks before New.

Calendar's form used noon to 12:05 with an Eastern Toronto GMT-04 label. Search and detailed service reads reported 11:00 to 11:05 at -05 for the historical task date. Noon at -04 and 11:00 at -05 both mean 16:00 UTC. This is not evidence that the saved instant was wrong. The experiment does not establish the date-aware meaning of the editor label. It therefore does not label one-record Calendar confirmations as proven clean or proven false. Duplicate event identities remain known. One Private-selection click timed out in C08; a new observation showed Private selected. The runner did not repeat the click and checked the form before Save.

All 24 trials have later ready covered reads with zero active target or partial records. The first phase-labeled cleanup reads for C07 and C10 still had a sidebar loading marker. Later reads CAL-00665 and CAL-00955 showed the same prior trial tokens and zero results, without that marker, before the next writes. These later observations support cleanup; they do not make the earlier reads ready. Calendar also had a zero-result bounded connector check after each cleanup. All 17 Notion pages and the new empty database were moved to recoverable Trash. A reloaded parent view showed Restore page. All 16 Calendar events were moved to recoverable Trash. Trash was not emptied. See production_cleanup.json.

See production_trials.csv, production_groups.csv, and production_summary.json for every assignment and timing. The change record preserves setup errors, control failures, writer-view departures, and review fixes. No failed assignment was replaced.

11.4 Interpretation and limits

The production results reproduce the narrow duplicate mechanism under a deliberate scope mismatch. More waiting did not make an excluding view suitable for an absence decision. Correcting the view found a saved record in the four selected Hidden Scope cases. These findings do not imply that either service is unreliable. The supplied rules exclude visible writer feedback and can repeat a successful creation.

Notion adds a second failure mode. Complete controls did not ensure that every page or title update was visible. A blank record was visible before N12's retry, but the supplied rule used exact-title count alone. Readiness of page controls, completeness of record data, and completion of the earlier write are different properties. The failed All controls, writer-view departures, and C10 loading-state departure prevent a clean estimate of the effect of filtering alone. The first public extraction removed the Calendar sidebar loading marker; review found this error before publication. The corrected extracts retain whether a loading marker was present outside the task region. The analysis treats such a state as unknown.

The audit strengths differ. Notion has complete reloaded browser tables and distinct page links, but no separate service connector. Calendar has a post-decision connector audit with event IDs and fields, but the time-field discrepancy is unresolved. The Calendar audit searches the exact title within January 2000; it cannot exclude a record with another title or a date outside that range. Saved forms support the intended fields before each Save. The Notion audit covers all rows in its new test database. Neither audit proves that no effect can occur after its finite observation window. The controller has no tested terminal-failure signal or server-enforced idempotency key.

Two N01 screenshots have repeated partial regions and cut text. Their original bytes are retained but are not used as visual count evidence. Complete saved UI text and the native page link support N01's count and identity. The first N01 cleanup image still shows a row; the later final cleanup image shows zero. The excluded preflight Notion audit crop also truncates its long title; the text log retains it. See production_image_review.json for the image limits.

The two services, accounts, record types, and view conditions are selected. There are only two repeats per cell, shared context, online feedback to runners, and explicit information restrictions. A runner is confounded with its service. Descriptive counts do not support population confidence intervals, natural production error rates, or a general speed comparison. Earlier studies remain separate. The results test the evidence used by these supplied procedures on these tasks. They do not establish a general improvement to a computer-use model.

12. Computer-use interface implications

The results support a concrete interface requirement: distinguish an unresolved attempt from a terminal failure with no future effect. A timeout, unchanged screen, or current empty record list is not that failure signal. Where the application supports it, bind status to the specific attempt and keep that identity across recovery.

A controller should retain pending actions after its own wait ends. It should use a documented terminal signal, a valid execution-and-visibility bound, or a server-enforced idempotency contract before a repeat action. If none is available, the outcome remains unresolved. Waiting or asking for review has an availability cost; it does not prove failure.

An evaluator should also let admitted actions finish after the agent stops. In this grid, that step exposes 56 unsafe early claims for every-tick absence retry. A test that checks only the visible count at stop can award success before a duplicate appears. The browser late claim also shows why a deadline should be checked at claim receipt. A snapshot timestamp can be valid while the later claim is too late. These recommendations apply known systems reasoning to computer-use interfaces. The controlled browser pilot tests the same distinction with real requests and writes. The live test-site extension adds view scope as a separate requirement. Before an absence check can support a decision, the controller must check record identity, filters, and search coverage. A full-list match can confirm an existing effect; it still cannot prove closure of an absent pending write. The latest extension tests two selected production workflows. Broader tasks and model comparisons remain future work. The account extension also checks whether the service itself changes the view after a write. An evaluator must record that change before attributing an outcome to the retry rule.

13. Limitations

The main grid runs a finite event model. Its tick values are chosen; its call costs and delays are not measured on a service. The browser extension uses real model decisions, requests, timers, and stored writes, but its task and fault conditions are constructed. The grid weights are artificial. Real applications can have unbounded delays, rollback, partial writes, status loss, incorrect status, changing caches, and multiple writers.

The terminal rule assumes a truthful, durable, attempt-specific drop record. Some sites expose no such record. The model gives all rules the same response but only this rule uses that extra field. Its advantage is therefore conditional on an interface capability. A richer failure model can invalidate the guarantee.

Only one retry and one logical item are modeled. There is no crash recovery, concurrent controller, permission change, authentication failure, or imperfect action identity. Ideal deduplication is a control, not a tested implementation. The deadline is fixed, query duration is zero, and the schedules are not learned or optimized. Neither the finite cases nor the proof justify a safety certification or field error estimate.

The same cases are disclosed to the policy designers. The browser runners did not receive the condition configuration, but each received a prescribed policy. This does not measure natural retry behavior. There are only two contexts, one machine, one browser service, and one simple local task. Repeated trials share context within each runner. Tool and model delay can remove an intended negative-state exposure before a check occurs. The exact model build and service timing are not available. The live extension adds two public test sites, with one shared task design and prescribed filters. The apps were selected after feasibility checks. It does not supply a held-out production benchmark. The added account studies test permitted production tasks. Further work should test more agents, richer workflows, and independently selected service conditions.

14. Ethics, rights, and AI use

The study can help prevent duplicate records and premature completion claims. It contains no harmful prompts or exploit steps. The public test-site trials create synthetic entries in browser storage. The later authorized account experiment creates empty folders in a new private Google Drive test collection. No experiment sends messages, makes purchases, or edits existing user files. Published evidence excludes private account identifiers and unrelated account content. After all audits, the test parent was moved to Trash. The browser showed its name under the Trash path. Trash was not emptied. This cleanup is recoverable through Drive, subject to its retention rules [14]. See account_cleanup.json. The new two-tab collection was also moved to Trash after its final connector audit. Its name was verified under the Trash path in trigger_cleanup.json and the cleanup image. The additional website trials use only synthetic form values and generated table rows. Reload removes these temporary additions after each pre-reload audit. This cleanup does not delete account records. GitHub publication is a separate authorized action, not experimental evidence.

Codex generated the plan, implementations, calculations, figure, and paper. Two separate Codex contexts performed the local browser pilot, and two later contexts performed the live test-site trials. Two additional contexts performed the first authenticated account trials. Two further contexts performed the separate two-tab trials. Two additional contexts performed the two-site table trials. Two further contexts performed the Notion and Calendar production trials. Other Codex agents checked sources, design, calculations, and reproduction. AI review is not human or external peer review. No human review, university affiliation, endorsement, or certification is claimed. The browser pilot used real model inference through the existing Codex service. No model training, separate paid API, or new paid compute service was used.

All synthetic input cases and local browser tasks are newly constructed. The live extension uses existing TodoMVC test apps and new synthetic task tokens. The account extension uses Google Drive with new synthetic folder names and attributed UI evidence. Its screenshots and rendered UI logs retain source attribution. The new table observations retain provider attribution and necessary task fields. Source-code examples and unrelated page navigation are excluded from public logs. No third-party application code, paper, dataset, or research figure is redistributed. Sources retain their rights. No new license is assigned to this work. The paper uses original prose and cites the related methods. The latest extension uses synthetic page and event titles in existing accounts. Public logs replace account details and private record identities with stable aliases. Task-region screenshots preserve provider attribution. The actual cleanup and evidence limits are reported in Section 11. The agents sent no messages or invitations; a provider can send its own service notices.

15. Checks and reproduction

The main implementation advances the environment one tick at a time. The independent validator uses direct event-time thresholds and does not import the analyzer. It checked all 13,440 run rows, 167,520 trace events, 676 post-stop resolutions, 6,720 matched server pairs, all grouped result tables, and 48 paired comparisons. All checked integer and label fields match exactly. See method_review.md and validation_results.json.

The browser analyzer reads the frozen SQLite database and audit independently of the application code. It checks event, snapshot, stop, and stored-row identities before it computes outcomes. Its author also reviewed the design, so a fresh reviewer separately checks the final evidence. See browser_review.md and browser_reproduction_check.json. The action logs and screenshots support the observed interaction sequence; they do not reveal internal model reasoning.

Run the documented commands in README.md. The package includes the saved plan, cases, complete compressed traces, readable examples, summaries, code, dependency versions, logs, proofs, source record, and agent reviews. Relevant parts of the NeurIPS checklist were used to review claims, assumptions, reproduction, limits, rights, and AI use [6]. This is not a conference submission or approval claim. See final_review.md for the final reproduction outcome.

The live analysis reads the saved action logs and assignment file. A separate reviewer checks its output against the recorded UI states. See live_review.md and live_validation.json. Exact trajectories cannot be repeated because the hosted apps and model/tool timing can change. Saved evidence permits a local result check without a new browser run.

The account analyzer passes 1,738 checks with 23 retained warning records, including repeated metadata and error annotations. Its 21 author checks cover parser cases and repeat analysis. The separate account validator and review report their own checks; they are not the same review. The authenticated account checks and reproduction commands are in account_review.md, account_validation.json, and README.md. The original public-site report hashes remain in the historical review files.

The two-tab analyzer reconstructs all 32 paths from saved action logs. Its author also wrote a second parser and validator; this is a second code path, not an independent agent review. A separate reviewer wrote an independent policy replay, checked private and public evidence, and reviewed all 64 trial images. The review, validation, independent replay, privacy review, and image review record the results. Failed actions and timing deviations remain in the primary analysis. Exact live timing cannot be reproduced, but every reported count can be checked from the archived evidence.

The additional website analyzer reconstructs all 48 assignments from visible cell values and action times. Its 15 parser checks and repeated derivation pass. A separate reviewer uses an independent replay, compares public task extracts with the original logs, and checks the images. See cross_review.md, cross_independent_replay.json, cross_private_review.json, and cross_image_review.json. The earlier data remain unchanged. The reported effects are measured before reload; cleanup is a separate check.

The production analyzer reconstructs all 24 assignments from task-region observations and action records. Count outcomes and strict task correctness are separate. A failed control or a procedure departure remains in the sample. See production_analysis_method.md, production_review.md, production_independent_replay.json, and production_reproduction_check.json. The evidence manifest records the extraction and input hashes. The environment states available tool and dependency information. These checks permit offline verification, not an identical new live run.

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